



Civil Rights Department

651 Bannan Street, Suite 200 | Sacramento | CA | 95811
1-800-884-1684 (voice) | 1-800-700-2320 (TTY) | California's Relay Service at 711
calcivilrights.ca.gov | contact.center@calcivilrights.ca.gov

April 13, 2026

Via Email: Redacted

Ayako Pham
Redacted

RE: Notice of Case Closure

Case Number: 202508-30598105

Case Name: Pham / Western Associates, Inc. and Subsidiary Southern Star Services, Ltd.

Case Type: Employment

EEOC Number: 37A-2026-00483

County of Violation: Los Angeles

Dear Ayako Pham:

The Civil Rights Department (CRD) has closed your case for the following reason(s): **No Basis to Proceed (For Filing Purposes Only)**.

CRD has not determined if further investigation might establish violation(s) of the law. This decision does not mean the alleged claims have no merit or that the respondent is following the law. This case closure is relevant to the allegations listed on the signed complaint only.

This is your Right to Sue notice. Government Code section 12965, subdivision (b), declares that you may file your own civil action asserting employment claims under FEHA within one year of the date of this letter. If you want to file a civil action that includes other claims, you should consult an attorney about the applicable statutes of limitation. The intake form for this case was submitted to CRD on August 4, 2025.

After receiving a Right-to-Sue notice from CRD, you may have the right to file your complaint with a local government agency that enforces employment anti-discrimination laws. If you decide to file with a local agency, you must file before the deadline that is on your Right-to-Sue notice. Filing your complaint with a local agency does not prevent you from also filing a lawsuit in court.

Your complaint **is dual filed** with the United States Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC). You have a right to request EEOC to perform a substantial weight review of our findings. This request must be made within fifteen (15) days of your receipt of this notice. Pursuant to Government code section 12965, subdivision (d) (1), your right to sue may be tolled during the pendency of EEOC's review of your complaint. To secure this review, you must request it in writing to the State and Local Coordinator:

**EEOC Southern California
Roybal Federal Building
255 East Temple Street, 4th Floor
Los Angeles, California 90012
Karrie.Maeda@eeoc.gov**

Although CRD has closed your case, the allegations and conduct at issue may be in violation of the law. You should consult an attorney as soon as possible regarding any other options and/or recourse you may have regarding the underlying acts or conduct. If a settlement or conciliation agreement has been signed resolving the complaint, it is likely that your right to file a private lawsuit may have been waived.

Below are some resources to assist you in deciding whether to bring a civil action on your own behalf in court in the State of California under the provisions of FEHA against the respondent(s) named in your complaint. To proceed in court, you should contact an attorney.

- The State Bar of California has a Lawyer Referral Services Program which can be accessed at <http://www.calbar.ca.gov> under the 'Public' link, or by calling 866-442-2529 (within California) or 415-538-2250 (outside California).
- Your local city or county may also have a lawyer referral or legal aid service.
- The California Courts website has a self-help guide, 'Small Claims in California,' that may be found at: <https://selfhelp.courts.ca.gov/small-claims-california>. Additional resources for small claims cases may be found at: <https://self-help.courts.ca.gov/resources-small-claims-cases>. You may also seek assistance by contacting the Small Claims Advisor, self-help center, or Small Claims Clerk's office for your county.

You have the right to appeal the closure of your case to CRD's Appeals Unit. To submit an appeal, you must complete the Appeal Request Form and submit it to the Appeals Unit within ten (10) calendar days of the date on this letter, which serves as the official notification of case closure.

For the Appeals Unit to consider your appeal, you must:

1. Download and complete the Appeal Request Form located on the CRD website: <https://calcivilrights.ca.gov/appeals>.

If you need assistance obtaining a copy of the Appeal Request Form or if you need assistance in completing the form, call CRD at 1-800-884-1684 (voice), 1-800-700-2320 (TTY), or by using California's Relay Service at 711.

2. Submit the completed Appeal Request Form within ten (10) calendar days of the date on this letter in one of the following ways:

- a) Email. Send your Appeal Request Form to: appeals@calcivilrights.ca.gov

OR

- b) Mail. Send your Appeal Request Form to: Civil Rights Department, Appeals Unit, 651 Bannon Street, Suite 200, Sacramento, CA 95811.

Please note, an appeal is not an opportunity to redo an investigation; it is an internal review of the investigation completed by CRD and all the evidence previously submitted to CRD. New evidence submitted with your appeal will not be reviewed by the Appeals Unit.

Sincerely,

Amber Coleman

Amber Coleman
Analyst I
916-937-4820
amber.coleman@calcivilrights.ca.gov

cc:

Western Associates, Inc. and Subsidiary Southern Star Services, Ltd.
[c/o chiba@wai.co.jp](mailto:c/o_chiba@wai.co.jp)